

BUILD A PROFILE THAT CONNECTS

IP Profile *Template Pack*

How to present your family to a surrogate – beautifully and honestly.

Includes: profile writing guide, bio worksheets, photo selection guide, what surrogates actually want to know, and Canva template.

Robyn Price

Executive Director, Canadian Surrogacy Options

In this field since I was four years old.

Your profile is your first impression.

Before a surrogate ever speaks to you, she will read your profile. She will look at your photos. She will read your story. And she will make a decision about whether she can imagine going on this journey with you.

I have reviewed hundreds of IP profiles over the years. I have seen profiles that made surrogates want to meet the family before they finished the first page. And I have seen profiles that made surrogates hesitant before they reached the second paragraph.

The difference is almost never about how perfect the family is. It is about how honest and how human they are willing to be.

"A surrogate is not looking for a perfect family. She is looking for a real one - one she trusts, one she connects with, and one she feels good handing a baby to."

This pack gives you the framework, the prompts, and the guidance to build a profile that does exactly that. Use the worksheets to draft, then build your final version in the Canva template included with this pack.

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What surrogates actually want to know

This is the section most IPs skip – and they shouldn't. Understanding what a surrogate is looking for changes how you write everything.

Who are you as people - not just as hopeful parents?

Surrogates want to feel like they know you. Your job, your hobbies, what makes you laugh, what your home feels like. The human stuff. Not your resume.

Why do you need a surrogate?

You do not need to share every medical detail. But a brief, honest explanation helps. It tells her this is real, and it helps her understand the significance of what she is doing.

What kind of relationship do you want during the pregnancy?

How often will you communicate? Will you attend appointments? How do you see this relationship working? She wants to know if your expectations are compatible with hers.

What will you be like as parents?

She is carrying this baby for someone. She wants to feel good about who that someone is. Give her a window into what kind of family this child is going to.

What happens after the birth?

Will you stay in touch? Send photos? Most surrogates are not looking for lifelong friendship – but most want to know this baby is loved and cared for. A simple honest statement goes a long way.

The profile structure - section by section

Here is what a strong IP profile includes and what to put in each section.

1 - MOST IMPORTANT

The opening letter

This is the most important part of your profile. It is the first thing she reads and it sets the entire tone. Write it as a letter directly to a potential surrogate – warm, personal, and from the heart.

✓ WORKS WELL

"If you are reading this, you are already someone extraordinary. We are Ali and Martin, and we have been waiting a long time to find the right person to help us build our family."

✗ AVOID

"We are a married couple from Ontario seeking a surrogate to carry our embryo."

2

Your story - why you need a surrogate

Keep it honest and keep it human. You do not need to share every clinical detail. But a brief, genuine explanation matters.

✓ WORKS WELL

"After three years and more appointments than we can count, we found out that carrying a pregnancy safely is not possible for me. It was a hard thing to accept. But it led us here, and here feels right."

✗ AVOID

"Due to medical reasons, we are unable to conceive naturally and require the assistance of a gestational carrier."

Individual bios

Each partner gets their own section. Keep it conversational – not a LinkedIn profile. Include: what you do for work (briefly), what you love, what you are like as a person, and something that makes you specific and real.

PRO TIP

Include something unexpected – a hobby, a quirk, a funny detail. "Martin cooks elaborate Sunday breakfasts that nobody asked for but everyone shows up for" tells her more about who he is than any professional accomplishment.

The profile structure - continued

4

Your home and family life

Describe where you live, what your home feels like, and who else is in your family – pets, children, extended family nearby. Help her picture the environment this baby is going to.

5

What you are looking for in a surrogate

Be specific but not demanding. What values matter to you? What kind of communication do you hope for? What does your ideal relationship during the pregnancy look like?

✓ WORKS WELL

"We are looking for someone who values open communication and feels comfortable reaching out when something feels off. We want to be present in this journey – not hovering, but genuinely involved and grateful at every step."

6

A closing note

End with something that feels like a conversation, not a contract. Thank her for reading. Tell her what it would mean to you. Invite her to reach out.

The photo selection guide

Photos are often the first thing a surrogate looks at. Here is exactly what works – and what to avoid.

PHOTOS THAT WORK WELL

A natural, smiling photo of you both together

Outdoors works beautifully. Candid is better than posed. You should look like yourselves.

A photo in your home

At the kitchen table, in the backyard, on the couch. Somewhere that feels real and lived-in.

A photo doing something you love

Cooking, hiking, at a farmers market, with your dog. Activity photos tell a story.

A photo with family

Parents, siblings, nieces and nephews. Helps her see the support system around you.

One photo that makes you laugh

A slightly ridiculous photo that shows you do not take yourselves too seriously.

PHOTOS TO AVOID

- × Overly formal or stiff portraits – they read as impersonal
- × Photos where you look unhappy or uncomfortable
- × Low quality, dark, or blurry images
- × Photos more than 3–4 years old
- × More than 8–10 photos total – quality over quantity

PHOTO TIP

If you don't have the right photos, take some this weekend. A phone camera in good natural light is all you need. Go somewhere you love and have someone take a few shots of you being yourselves.

What to avoid in your profile

These are the patterns that make surrogates hesitant. Most are well-intentioned – which is exactly why they are worth flagging.

Overloading with medical information

"After 4 failed IVF cycles, 2 laparoscopies, and a diagnosis of..."

A brief, honest explanation is enough. The medical details belong in your intake file, not your profile. Too much medical information can feel overwhelming and shifts the tone from a human connection to a clinical transaction.

Language that sounds like a job posting

"We require a surrogate who is reliable, punctual, and committed to following all medical protocols."

You are looking for a relationship, not an employee. Language like this creates distance and signals that you may be difficult to work with.

Over-promising closeness

"We will treat you like family!" or "You will always be part of our lives!"

Surrogates are experienced in reading profiles. Empty promises read as empty. Be honest about what you genuinely see this relationship being.

Being vague about your situation

"We prefer not to share details until we have spoken."

Transparency builds trust. If you are withholding basic information in your profile, it raises questions about what else you might withhold. Share the essentials.

Focusing entirely on what you want

A profile that is all about your hopes, your needs, your expectations - with no acknowledgement of what this means for the surrogate.

Balance matters. Acknowledge her. Express genuine gratitude for what she is considering doing.

Using the Canva template

Your purchase includes access to a professionally designed Canva template in CSO's purple and lavender palette. Here is how to use it.

1

Access the template

The Canva template link is included in your purchase confirmation email. Click the link and select "Use template" to create your own copy. You will need a free Canva account.

2

Replace the placeholder text

Every text block in the template is a placeholder. Click on any text block to edit it. Use the worksheets in this pack to have your content ready before you start editing.

3

Add your photos

Click on any photo placeholder and select "Replace" to upload your own images. Canva will automatically fit them to the frame. For best results use images that are at least 1200px wide.

4

Adjust colours if needed

The template uses CSO's brand colours. If your agency has different brand guidelines, you can update the colour palette in Canva's brand kit or by selecting individual elements.

5

Export your profile

When you are happy with your profile, click "Share" then "Download" and export as PDF. Standard quality is fine for digital sharing. For print, select "PDF Print" and high quality.

6

Create two versions

Consider creating a full version with all your details, and a simplified version with your names changed for privacy. Your agency can advise on which to use and when.

WORKSHEETS

Draft your profile *here first.*

Write your answers here before you open Canva. Having your content drafted first makes the design process much faster – and the writing much better.

Your Opening Letter

Write a letter directly to a potential surrogate. Aim for 150–250 words. Warm, honest, personal.

OPENING LINE – HOW DO YOU WANT TO START?

WHY DO YOU NEED A SURROGATE? (HONEST AND BRIEF)

WHAT DOES BECOMING PARENTS MEAN TO YOU?

WHAT DO YOU WANT HER TO KNOW ABOUT YOU BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE?

CLOSING – WHAT DO YOU WANT TO LEAVE HER WITH?

Your Individual Bios

Complete one section for each partner. Aim for 80–120 words each.

PERSON 1

NAME

WHAT DO YOU DO FOR WORK? (BRIEFLY)

WHAT DO YOU LOVE? (HOBBIES, PASSIONS, THINGS THAT LIGHT YOU UP)

SOMETHING SPECIFIC AND REAL THAT TELLS HER WHO YOU ARE

PERSON 2

NAME

WHAT DO YOU DO FOR WORK? (BRIEFLY)

WHAT DO YOU LOVE?

Your Home & Family Life

WHERE DO YOU LIVE? WHAT DOES YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD / HOME FEEL LIKE?

WHO ELSE IS IN YOUR FAMILY? (PETS, CHILDREN, EXTENDED FAMILY NEARBY)

WHAT DOES A TYPICAL WEEKEND LOOK LIKE IN YOUR HOME?

WHAT KIND OF HOME IS THIS BABY COMING INTO?

What You're Looking For

WHAT KIND OF PERSON ARE YOU HOPING TO MATCH WITH?

WHAT DOES COMMUNICATION DURING THE PREGNANCY LOOK LIKE FOR YOU?

HOW INVOLVED DO YOU WANT TO BE DURING THE PREGNANCY?

WHAT WILL YOU DO TO SHOW UP FOR HER THROUGHOUT THIS JOURNEY?

WHAT DO YOU SEE THE RELATIONSHIP LOOKING LIKE AFTER THE BIRTH?

YOU'RE READY.

Build your profile. *Find your match.*

You now have everything you need to build a profile that is honest, warm, and genuinely compelling. Use the worksheets to draft your content, then bring it to life in the Canva template.

If you would like a professional review of your profile before it goes live, CSO offers profile review consultations. And if you are ready to take the next step and work with an agency, we would love to talk.

[Book a free 30-minute call with Robyn](#)

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Little Miracles Egg Donation Services · little-miracles.ca

This guide is provided for informational purposes only. Profile content is the responsibility of the intended parents.

Canadian Surrogacy Options does not guarantee any specific matching outcome.